EDITION 01 · ENGLISH · GOLD FIRST

7-STEP PROTOCOL

The same seven steps, in the same order, on every trade you take.

No indicators. No prediction. A routine you run from a clean chart to a closed position — written for gold, and it works on any pair. Results here are in pips and R, never in currency.

SAMBANGGOLD

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SEVEN STEPS

Steps 1 to 4 decide whether a trade exists. Steps 5 to 7 execute it. Skipping a step is how a plan becomes a guess.

REFERENCE

01 CLEAN THE CHART

> Goal: one chart, one instrument, nothing on it but price.

Every indicator on your chart is a calculation of the same price you are already looking at, arriving late. Remove all of them. What is left is the only information the market actually gives you: where price went, how fast, and where it stopped.

Then fix your daily close. Charts differ by broker: some close the daily candle at New York, others at midnight in their own server time zone. Two brokers can show the same day as a different candle, which means different daily levels and different signals. Pick a chart whose daily candle closes at the New York close and stay on it — the levels you mark are only as consistent as the chart you mark them on.

SETUP, ONCE

1. Delete every indicator, oscillator and expert advisor from the chart.
2. Set candlesticks, not lines or bars.
3. Confirm the daily candle closes at the New York close.
4. Save it as your template so every new chart opens the same way.

02 MARK THE LEVELS

> Goal: three levels on the daily chart, and a rule for when to look closer.

Support is where buyers have already defended price. Resistance is where sellers have. Neither is a magic line — they are places where orders once piled up, and tend to pile up again.

Mark them on the daily chart, not the 5-minute. Use candlestick bodies rather than wick tips, because wicks overshoot. Draw zones a few dollars wide on gold, not hairlines — price does not stop on round numbers because they look tidy. Then stop at three. A chart covered in lines means you never chose anything.

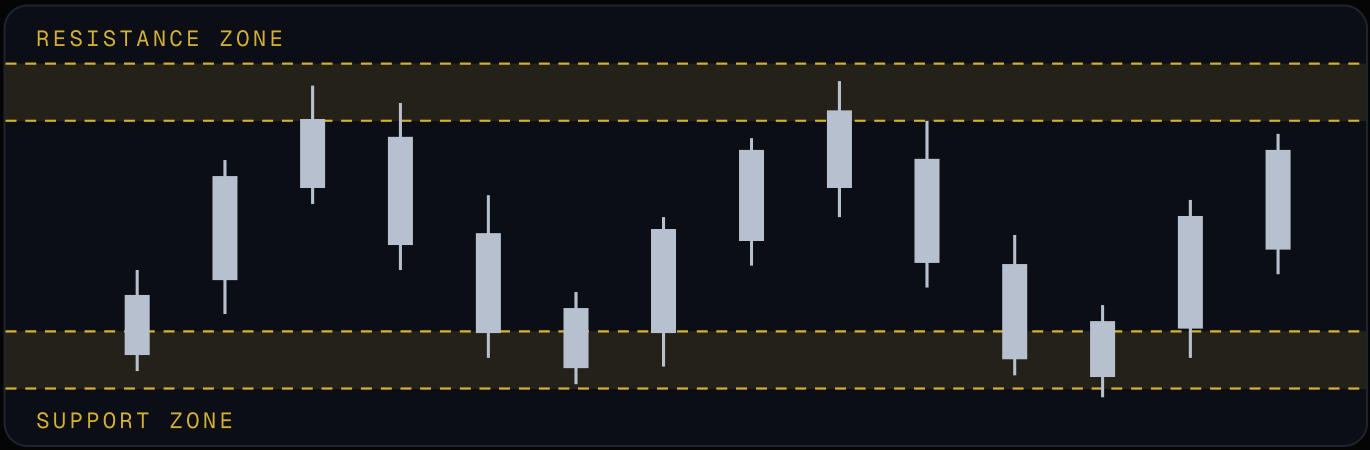


FIGURE 02 · TWO ZONES, DRAWN FROM BODIES. PRICE WORKS BETWEEN THEM UNTIL ONE GIVES WAY.

RULE 02 · TOP DOWN, NOT ALL DAY

Mark the daily level first, then leave the chart alone. Only when price moves into that level do you drop to 4-hour and 1-hour to look for a trigger. Watching every lower time frame all day costs hours and produces worse trades, not better ones.

03 NAME THE MARKET TYPE

> Goal: say out loud which of three states the market is in, with evidence.

A trend is higher highs and higher lows, or lower highs and lower lows. A range is price rotating between two levels with no progress. If you cannot point at two highs and two lows that fit the pattern, you do not have a trend — you have a hope.

In a trend, trade with it. Counter-trend trades are the most expensive lesson beginners buy. In a range, trade the edges or nothing at all — and in the middle of a range, there is no trade to be had at any price.

FIGURE 03 · THREE STATES. ONLY TWO OF THEM PAY.

04 READ THE CONTEXT

> Goal: check that the trade has room to work, at a time when the market is awake.

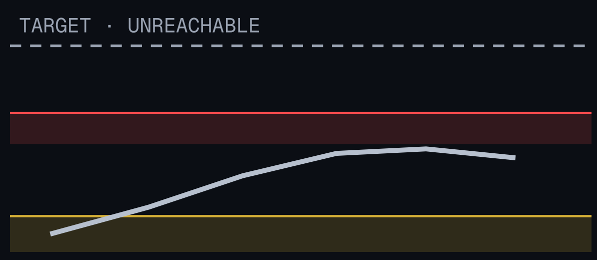
A good level with no space in front of it is a bad trade. If the next opposing level sits closer than your first target, the market has to fight through it to pay you. Measure the space before you commit: clear room to the target, or no trade.

Timing matters as much as location. Gold is thin and jumpy through the Asian session and moves properly when London and New York overlap. And a high-impact release — US inflation, jobs, a central-bank decision — turns clean structure into noise for an hour. No new entries 30 minutes either side of one.

SPACE TO RUN — Take it

Nothing between entry and target 2. The trade only needs price to move.

LEVEL IN THE WAY — Skip it



An opposing level sits inside the run. It has to break before you are paid.

FIGURE 04 · THE GOLD BLOCK IS YOUR ENTRY LEVEL. THE SECOND SETUP HAS TO BREAK ANOTHER LEVEL TO PAY.

05 WAIT FOR THE TRIGGER

> Goal: enter on a closed candlestick signal at your level — or not at all.

Steps 1 to 4 told you where. The trigger tells you when. It is a single closed candlestick at your level that shows one side losing the fight. Three are enough to start with, and all three are read after the candle closes, never while it is still moving.

REJECTION

A long wick into the level and a close back out of it. Price tried, and was pushed back.

ENGULFING CLOSE

A candle whose body covers the previous one and closes past it, in your direction.

BREAK AND RETEST

Price breaks the level, comes back to it, and is rejected from the other side.

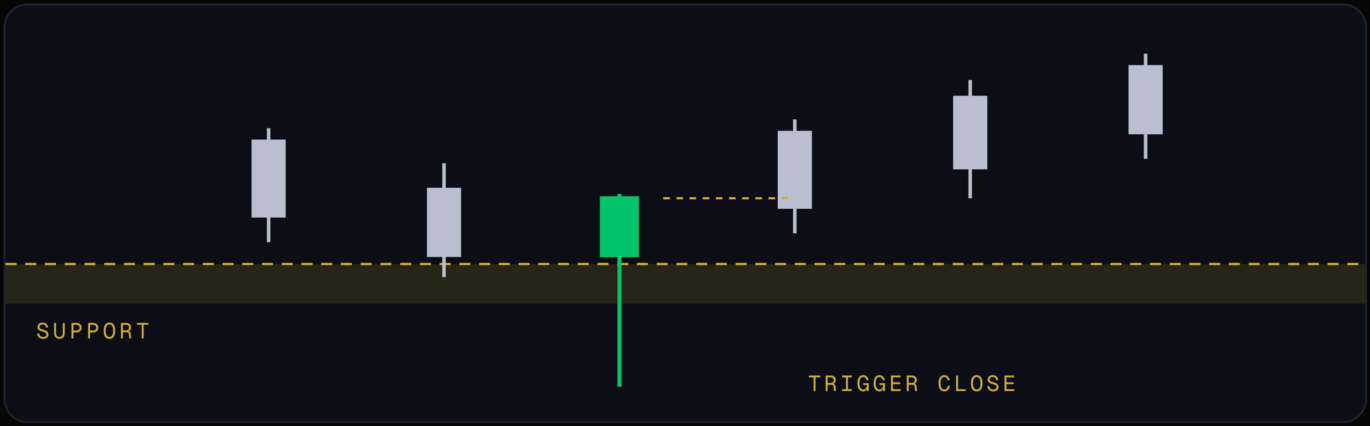


FIGURE 05 · THIRD CANDLE: LONG LOWER WICK THROUGH SUPPORT, CLOSE BACK ABOVE IT. THAT CLOSE IS THE TRIGGER.

06 WRITE THE PRE-TRADE PLAN

> Goal: four numbers on paper before the order is sent.

Entry, stop loss, position size, targets. Written down while you are calm, because you will not think this clearly once money is moving. The stop goes on the far side of the level that gave you the trigger — if price closes through there, the reason you entered is gone.

The distance from entry to stop is 1R, one unit of risk. Size the position so 1R costs 1% of the account, and express every target as a multiple of it. Minimum 1:2 — with 1:3, four wins out of ten still leaves you ahead by 6R.

+3R	Target 2
+1.5R	Target 1 · take half
0R	Entry · on the trigger close
−1R	Stop · beyond the level

FIGURE 06 · POSITION SIZE IS CHOSEN SO THAT THE −1R LINE COSTS EXACTLY 1% OF THE ACCOUNT.

07 MANAGE IT TO THE EXIT

> Goal: follow the plan you already wrote, and nothing else.

Most traders win more often than they lose and still go backwards. The gap is not entries — it is exits. Good entries are undone by decisions made while the position is open, and every one of those decisions was already answered in step 6.

AT TARGET 1

Close half, move the stop to breakeven. The rest of the trade is now free of risk.

WHILE IT RUNS

Trail the stop behind structure — under each new higher low, not at a fixed distance.

NEVER

Widen the stop, remove it, or add to a losing position. This is the one-way rule.

THEN

Record the result in R, note whether you followed the plan, and close the platform.

RULE 07 · JUDGE THE PROCESS, NOT THE RESULT

A trade that followed all seven steps and lost 1R is a good trade. A trade that broke the plan and won is a bad one — it teaches a habit that will cost you later. SamBangGold publishes its losses for the same reason: a record that hides the −1R trades cannot be checked.

ONE TRADE, ALL SEVEN STEPS

Illustrative numbers on XAUUSD, not a past result. The point is the sequence, not the outcome.

01 **Chart is clean**

Naked candlesticks, New York daily close, one chart open.

02 **Daily support zone at 2 380–2 384**

Three daily closes have been defended there in the last two months.

03 **Market type: uptrend**

Two higher highs and two higher lows on the daily. Buys only.

04 **Context clears**

Next resistance is 2 410, well beyond target 2. It is 21:10 MYT, inside the overlap. No release for the next four hours.

INSTRUMENT	DIRECTION	SESSION
XAUUSD	BUY	Overlap

05 **Trigger: 4-hour rejection**

A 4-hour candle wicks to 2 381.20 and closes back at 2 386.40, above the zone.

06 **Plan written before entry**

Entry 2 386.40 · stop 2 379.40 (below the zone) · 1R = $7.00 · target 1 at 2 396.90 (+1.5R) · target 2 at 2 407.40 (+3R). Size set so 1R costs 1% of the account.

07 **Managed as planned**

Target 1 hits, half closed, stop moved to breakeven. The remainder trails under the new higher low and closes at 2 405.10 as momentum stalls short of target 2.

ENTRY	STOP	1R	CLOSED
2 386.40	2 379.40	$7.00	+2.2R

IF IT HAD STOPPED OUT

The same seven steps, ending at −1R. Nothing in the process was wrong — the level simply failed, which it will do a third of the time or more. That is what the 1% rule is for, and why results are counted over fifty trades rather than one.

THE ONE-PAGE CHECKLIST

Seven boxes. If one cannot be ticked, there is no trade — and no trade is a complete decision.

- [ ] 01 The chart is clean and closes at New York.
- [ ] 02 Three daily levels are marked, drawn from bodies.
- [ ] 03 I can name the market type and point at the evidence.
- [ ] 04 There is clear space to target 2, and no release within 30 minutes.
- [ ] 05 A candlestick trigger has closed at the level.
- [ ] 06 Entry, stop, size and targets are written down. 1R = 1% of the account.
- [ ] 07 The management plan is set: partial, breakeven, trail, record.

RISK PER TRADE

1% of the balance, every trade, regardless of how good the setup feels.

SESSION END

Two losses today closes the platform. Tomorrow is a new set of seven boxes.

GLOSSARY

Every term this book uses, in the order you meet them.

`XAUUSD`
The price of one ounce of gold in US dollars.

`Candlestick`
One period of price: open, high, low, close.

`Body · wick`
The thick part is open to close; the thin lines are prices tried and rejected.

`Support`
A level where buyers have previously stopped price falling.

`Resistance`
A level where sellers have previously stopped price rising.

`Time frame`
The period one candlestick covers. Daily, 4-hour, 1-hour.

`Trend`
Higher highs and higher lows, or lower highs and lower lows.

`Range`
Price rotating between two levels without making progress.

`Trigger`
The closed candlestick at your level that starts the trade.

`Entry`
The planned price at which you open the position.

`Stop loss`
The automatic exit if you are wrong. Its distance from entry is 1R.

`Take profit`
The automatic exit if you are right. Expressed as a multiple of R.

`R`
One unit of risk. +2R means twice the stop distance in profit.

`Risk-reward`
The ratio of stop distance to target distance. Minimum 1:2.

`Breakeven`
Moving the stop to your entry price, so the trade can no longer lose.

`News lockout`
The 30 minutes either side of a high-impact release: no new entries.

SAME ORDER, EVERY TIME

Nothing in these seven steps is clever, and that is the point. The protocol works because it is boring enough to repeat on a bad day. Run it on demo for twenty trades before a live account, and keep the checklist where you can see it.

SamBangGold publishes gold setups with entry, stop and targets — including the ones that stop out. Read them against this protocol: if a signal does not pass your own steps 3 and 4, you are allowed to let it go.